AI & Tech News Digest

Evening Edition -- Today's Top Stories

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1 Microsoft Winds Down AI Cloud Capacity Deal with Oracle

Microsoft is beginning to scale back its arrangement with Oracle to rent external AI cloud capacity, according to recent reports. During the initial AI boom, Microsoft relied heavily on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure to supplement Azure's capacity constraints for training and running large AI models. As Microsoft continues to expand its own custom data centers and specialized AI hardware installations, it no longer relies as heavily on third-party cloud rentals. This shift marks a key transition phase in cloud infrastructure scaling for enterprise generative AI.

Why it matters:
Cloud operations engineers should expect shifts in multi-cloud hosting strategies as tech giants bring AI compute back in-house. Relying on rented third-party infrastructure is proving to be a temporary bridge rather than a permanent enterprise solution.

Source: Reuters | https://www.reuters.com/business/microsoft-is-winding-down-oracle-deal-rent-ai-c...

2 Perplexity Unveils AI 'Teammate' Agents for Ongoing Enterprise Work

Perplexity has launched a new class of AI agents called 'Teammates' aimed at supporting complex, multi-step workflows in business environments. Unlike traditional chat interfaces that answer single queries, these agents operate continuously in the background to conduct research, monitor data sources, and collaborate with human teams. They can integrate into team workspaces to provide persistent assistance on ongoing projects without requiring constant manual prompting. This launch reflects a broader industry movement from simple conversational LLM tools toward fully autonomous agentic workflows.

Why it matters:
For engineering and operations teams, autonomous AI agents represent the next evolution in task automation beyond static CI/CD scripts. Integrating agents into daily workflows will require clearer permission models and standardized API integration layers.

Source: Perplexity | https://www.perplexity.ai/en-GB/hub/blog/teammates-are-agents-for-complex-ongoin...

3 University Libraries Face Server Outages Due to Aggressive AI Scraping Bots

Academic institutions and university libraries are reporting severe system disruptions caused by aggressive automated AI data-scraping bots. AI companies seeking massive datasets to train next-generation models are flooding public library repositories with millions of automated HTTP requests. This intense traffic spike is crashing academic servers and forcing libraries to implement aggressive firewall rules or restrict public digital access altogether. The situation highlights growing tension between open-access public knowledge repositories and unchecked commercial AI training data collection.

Why it matters:
Systems engineers and platform architects managing public APIs must double down on sophisticated rate-limiting, edge caching, and bot detection mechanisms. Protecting open digital infrastructure from indiscriminate AI scraping without blocking legitimate human users is becoming a critical operations

challenge.

Source: CBC News | https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/university-libraries-ai-data-scraping-bots-9.74082...